



DAVID SLAYS GOLIATH AT LORD'S, AND SRI LANKA'S FIRST WORLD CUP

The T20 World Cup has had many **unforgettable moments** in its eight editions, which have contributed to its popularity. Here are a few.

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The T20 format emerged as an innovative spectacle aimed at captivating audiences with its fast-paced action, symbolised by the brisk flight of the white Kookaburra ball. Initially met with skepticism from purists and players alike, its potential as a serious cricketing endeavour was doubted.

However, in 2007, the inaugural World Twenty20 tournament signalled a significant shift. Over the ensuing 17 years, what was once dismissed as a mere entertainment gimmick has evolved into a cricket powerhouse. Today, T20 cricket commands a fervent following, surpassing even the traditional bastion of One Day Internationals (ODIs), which now struggles to maintain its relevance beyond its quadrennial pinnacle.

In the eight editions of the T20 World Cup, there have been numerous unforgettable moments that have contributed to the format's popularity.

► GIBBS STEALS GAYLE'S THUNDER

It began with an exciting knock from two of cricket's biggest names, Chris Gayle and Herschelle Gibbs of the West Indies and South Africa.

The Gayle storm hit Johannesburg on September 11, 2007, during the opening game of the World Twenty20. The West Indian opener scored a whopping 117 runs off just 57 balls, hitting the ball out of the park multiple times. The West Indies finished its innings at 205/6. South Africa then chased the total down with 14 balls to spare and eight wickets in hand, thanks to Gibbs' unbeaten 90 off 55 balls.

This game had it all: a 50-ball hundred, 18 sixes, and a total of 413 runs scored. This moment marked the arrival of the World T20 and set the standard for how the game would be played — full of excitement and entertainment.